
INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE

UNIT 1 ASPECTS OF DRAMATIC TRAGEDY

Tuesday 05 January 2021

07:00 GMT

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an Oxford International AQA Examinations 12-page answer book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **one** question from Section A and **one** question from Section B.
- Remember to include, in both your answers, relevant comments on the authors' dramatic methods in the set texts you are studying.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- You will be marked on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - analyse carefully the writers' methods
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

Section A: Elizabethan and Jacobean tragedy

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Othello and Iago
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 4 Scene 1

Enter Iago and Othello

IAGO

Will you think so?

OTHELLO

Think so, Iago!

IAGO

What,

To kiss in private?

OTHELLO

An unauthorized kiss!

IAGO

Or to be naked with her friend in bed

An hour or more, not meaning any harm?

OTHELLO

Naked in bed, Iago, and not mean harm!

It is hypocrisy against the devil.

They that mean virtuously, and yet do so,

The devil their virtue tempts, and they tempt heaven.

IAGO

So they do nothing, 'tis a venial slip:

But if I give my wife a handkerchief –

OTHELLO

What then?

IAGO

Why, then, 'tis hers, my lord; and, being hers,

She may, I think, bestow't on any man.

OTHELLO

She is protectress of her honour too:

May she give that?

IAGO

Her honour is an essence that's not seen,
They have it very oft that have it not.
But, for the handkerchief –

OTHELLO

By heaven, I would most gladly have forgot it!
Thou said'st – O, it comes o'er my memory
As doth the raven o'er the infected house,
Boding to all – he had my handkerchief.

IAGO

Ay – what of that?

OTHELLO

That's not so good now.

IAGO

What

If I had said I had seen him do you wrong?
Or heard him say – as knaves be such abroad,
Who, having, by their own importunate suit
Or voluntary dotage of some mistress
Convinced or supplied them, cannot choose
But they must blab –

OTHELLO

Hath he said anything?

IAGO

He hath, my lord, but be you well assured,
No more than he'll unswear.

OTHELLO

What hath he said?

IAGO

'Faith, that he did – I know not what he did.

OTHELLO

What? What?

IAGO

Lie.

OTHELLO

With her?

IAGO

With her, on her – what you will.

OTHELLO

Lie with her? Lie on her? We say 'lie on her' when they belie her. Lie with her?
'Swounds, that's fulsome. Handkerchief – confessions – handkerchief! To confess, and
be hanged for his labour? First, to be hanged, and then to confess! I tremble at it.
Nature would not invest herself in such shadowing passion without some instruction. It
is not words that shake me thus. Pish! Noses, ears, and lips!
Is't possible? Confess? Handkerchief? O, devil!

He falls down in a trance

This extract continues on the next page

IAGO

Work on, my medicine, work! Thus credulous fools are caught,
And many worthy and chaste dames even thus,
All guiltless, meet reproach. What ho, my lord!
My lord, I say! Othello!

Enter Cassio

How now, Cassio!

CASSIO

What's the matter?

IAGO

My lord is fallen into an epilepsy –
This is his second fit; he had one yesterday.

or

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Edgar and Edmund
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scenes 1 and 2

Scene 1

Enter EDGAR disguised as a peasant

EDGAR

If e'er your grace had speech with man so poor,
Hear me one word.

ALBANY (to the others)

I'll overtake you.

Exeunt all but ALBANY and EDGAR

Speak.

EDGAR

Before you fight the battle, ope this letter.
If you have victory, let the trumpet sound
For him that brought it. Wretched though I seem,
I can produce a champion that will prove
What is avouched there. If you miscarry,
Your business of the world hath so an end.
Fortune love you –

ALBANY

Stay till I have read the letter.

EDGAR

I was forbid it.
When time shall serve, let but the herald cry,
And I'll appear again.

ALBANY

Why, fare thee well. I will o'erlook the paper.

Exit EDGAR

Enter EDMUND

EDMUND

The enemy's in view; draw up your powers.

He offers Albany a paper

This extract continues on the next page

[EDMUND]

Here is the guess of their great strength and forces
By diligent discovery; but your haste
Is now urged on you.

ALBANY

We will greet the time.

Exit

EDMUND

To both these sisters have I sworn my love;
Each jealous of the other as the stung
Are of the adder. Which of them shall I take? –
Both? – one? – or neither? Neither can be enjoyed,
If both remain alive: to take the widow
Exasperates, makes mad, her sister Goneril;
And hardly shall I carry out my side,
Her husband being alive. Now then, we'll use
His countenance for the battle, which being done,
Let her who would be rid of him devise
His speedy taking off. As for the mercy
Which he intends to Lear and to Cordelia,
The battle done, and they within our power,
Shall never see his pardon; for my state
Stands on me to defend, not to debate.

Exit

Scene 2

Alarum. The powers of France pass over the stage led by Queen Cordelia with her father in her hand. Then enter Edgar disguised as a peasant, guiding the blind Earl of Gloucester.

EDGAR

Here, father, take the shadow of this bush
For your good host; pray that the right may thrive.
If ever I return to you again,
I'll bring you comfort.

Exit EDGAR

GLOUCESTER

Grace go with you, sir!

Alarum and retreat. Enter EDGAR

EDGAR

Away, old man. Give me thy hand. Away.
King Lear hath lost, he and his daughter ta'en:
Give me thy hand. Come on.

GLOUCESTER

No farther, sir. A man may rot even here.

EDGAR

What, in ill thoughts again? Men must endure
Their going hence even as their coming hither.
Ripeness is all. Come on.

Exeunt

or

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Hamlet and Horatio
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 3 Scene 2

HAMLET

What ho, Horatio!

Enter Horatio

HORATIO

Here, sweet lord, at your service.

HAMLET

Horatio, thou art e'en as just a man
As e'er my conversation coped withal.

HORATIO

O, my dear lord –

HAMLET

Nay, do not think I flatter;
For what advancement may I hope from thee
That no revenue hast but thy good spirits,
To feed and clothe thee? Why should the poor be flattered?
No, let the candied tongue lick absurd pomp,
And crook the pregnant hinges of the knee
Where thrift may follow fawning. Dost thou hear?
Since my dear soul was mistress of her choice
And could of men distinguish, her election
Hath seal'd thee for herself. For thou hast been
As one, in suffering all, that suffers nothing,
A man that Fortune's buffets and rewards
Hast ta'en with equal thanks; and blest are those
Whose blood and judgment are so well commingled
That they are not a pipe for Fortune's finger
To sound what stop she please. Give me that man
That is not passion's slave, and I will wear him
In my heart's core, ay, in my heart of heart,
As I do thee. Something too much of this.

This extract continues on the next page

[HAMLET]

There is a play to-night before the King.
One scene of it comes near the circumstance
Which I have told thee of my father's death.
I prithee, when thou seest that act afoot,
Even with the very comment of thy soul
Observe mine uncle. If his occulted guilt
Do not itself unkennel in one speech,
It is a damned ghost that we have seen,
And my imaginations are as foul
As Vulcan's stithy. Give him heedful note;
For I mine eyes will rivet to his face;
And, after, we will both our judgments join
In censure of his seeming.

HORATIO

Well, my lord.
If he steal aught the whilst this play is playing,
And 'scape detecting, I will pay the theft.

HAMLET

They are coming to the play. I must be idle.
Get you a place.

A Danish March. A flourish of trumpets. Enter Claudius, Gertrude, Polonius, Ophelia, Rosencrantz, Guildenstern, and other lords attendant, with the King's guard carrying torches

KING CLAUDIUS

How fares our cousin Hamlet?

HAMLET

Excellent, I' faith; of the chameleon's dish. I eat
the air, promise-crammed. You cannot feed capons so.

KING CLAUDIUS

I have nothing with this answer, Hamlet; these words
are not mine.

HAMLET

No, nor mine now.

or

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the different characters
- Marlowe's use of dramatic language
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scene 1

Thunder and lightning. Enter DEVILS with covered dishes. Mephistopheles leads them into Faustus's study. Then enter Wagner.

WAGNER

I think my master means to die shortly;
He has made his will, and given me his wealth,
His house, his goods, and store of golden plate,
Besides two thousand ducats ready coined.
I wonder what he means. If death were nigh,
He would not frolic thus. He's now at supper
With the scholars, where there's such belly-cheer
As Wagner in his life ne'er saw the like.
And, see where they come. Belike the feast is done.

Exit Wagner. Enter Faustus, Mephistopheles, and two or three Scholars

FIRST SCHOLAR

Master Doctor Faustus, since our conference about fair ladies – which was the beautifullest in all the world – we have determined with ourselves that Helen of Greece was the admirablest lady that ever lived. Therefore, Master Doctor, if you will do us so much favour as to let us see that peerless dame of Greece, whom all the world admires for majesty, we should think ourselves much beholding unto you.

FAUSTUS

Gentlemen,
For that I know your friendship is unfeign'd,
It is not Faustus' custom to deny
The just request of those that wish him well:
You shall behold that peerless dame of Greece,
No otherwise for pomp or majesty
Than when Sir Paris crossed the seas with her,
And brought the spoils to rich Dardania.
Be silent, then, for danger is in words.

Mephistopheles goes to the door. Music sounds. Mephistopheles brings in Helen. She passeth over the stage.

This extract continues on the next page

SECOND SCHOLAR

Was this fair Helen, whose admired worth
Made Greece with ten years' war afflict poor Troy?

THIRD SCHOLAR

Too simple is my wit to tell her worth,
Whom all the world admires for majesty.

FIRST SCHOLAR

Now we have seen the pride of Nature's work,
We'll take our leaves: and, for this blessed sight
Happy and blest be Faustus evermore!

FAUSTUS

Gentlemen, farewell. The same wish I to you.

Exeunt Scholars. Enter an Old Man.

OLD MAN

O gentle Faustus, leave this damned art,
This magic, that will charm thy soul to hell
And quite bereave thee of salvation!
Though thou hast now offended like a man,
Do not persevere in it like a devil.
Yet, yet thou hast an amiable soul,
If sin by custom grow not into nature.
Then, Faustus, will repentance come too late;
Then thou art banish'd from the sight of heaven:
No mortal can express the pains of hell.
It may be this my exhortation
Seems harsh and all unpleasant. Let it not;
For, gentle son, I speak it not in wrath
Or envy of thee, but in tender love,
And pity of thy future misery;
And so have hope that this my kind rebuke,
Checking thy body, may amend thy soul.

FAUSTUS

Where art thou, Faustus? Wretch, what hast thou done?
Hell claims his right, and with a roaring voice
Says, 'Faustus, come! Thine hour is almost come.'

Mephistopheles gives him a dagger

And Faustus now will come to do thee right.

Faustus prepares to stab himself

OLD MAN

O, stay, good Faustus, stay thy desperate steps!
I see an angel hover o'er thy head,
And, with a vial full of precious grace
Offers to pour the same into thy soul.
Then call for mercy, and avoid despair.

or

0	5
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John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Ferdinand and the Cardinal
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 2 Scene 5

Enter Cardinal and Ferdinand with a letter

FERDINAND

I have this night digg'd up a mandrake.

CARDINAL

Say you?

FERDINAND

And I am grown mad with 't.

CARDINAL

What 's the prodigy?

FERDINAND

Read there, a sister damned; she's loose l' the hilts;
Grown a notorious strumpet.
Speak lower.

FERDINAND

Lower!

Rogues do not whisper 't now, but seek to publish 't
As servants do the bounty of their lords
Aloud; and with a covetous searching eye,
To mark who note them. O, confusion seize her!
She hath had most cunning bawds to serve her turn,
And more secure conveyances for lust
Than towns of garrison for service.

CARDINAL

Is 't possible?
Can this be certain?

FERDINAND

Rhubarb, O, for rhubarb
To purge this choler! Here 's the cursed day
To prompt my memory, and here 't shall stick
Till of her bleeding heart I make a sponge
To wipe it out.

This extract continues on the next page

CARDINAL

Why do you make yourself
So wild a tempest?

FERDINAND

Would I could be one,
That I might toss her palace 'bout her ears,
Root up her goodly forests, blast her meads,
And lay her general territory as waste
As she hath done her honours.

CARDINAL

Shall our blood,
The royal blood of Aragon and Castile,
Be thus attainted?

FERDINAND

Apply desperate physic:
We must not now use balsamum, but fire,
The smarting cupping-glass, for that's the mean
To purge infected blood, such blood as hers.
There is a kind of pity in mine eye,
I'll give it to my handkercher; and now 'tis here,
I'll bequeath this to her bastard.

CARDINAL

What to do?

FERDINAND

Why, to make soft lint for his mother's wounds,
When I have hew'd her to pieces.

CARDINAL

Curs'd creature!
Unequal nature, to place women's hearts
So far upon the left side!

FERDINAND

Foolish men,
That e'er will trust their honour in a bark
Made of so slight, weak bulrush as is woman,
Apt every minute to sink it!

CARDINAL

Thus ignorance, when it hath purchas'd honour,
It cannot wield it.

FERDINAND

Methinks I see her laughing,
Excellent hyena! Talk to me somewhat, quickly,
Or my imagination will carry me
To see her in the shameful act of sin.

CARDINAL

With whom?

FERDINAND

Happily with some strong-thigh'd bargeman,
Or one o' th' wood-yard that can quoit the sledge
Or toss the bar, or else some lovely squire
That carries coals up to her privy lodgings.

CARDINAL

You fly beyond your reason.

FERDINAND

Go to, mistress!

'Tis not your whore's milk that shall quench my wild-fire,
But your whore's blood.

CARDINAL

How idly shows this rage, which carries you,
As men convey'd by witches through the air,
On violent whirlwinds! This intemperate noise
Fitly resembles deaf men's shrill discourse,
Who talk aloud, thinking all other men
To have their imperfection.

Turn over for Section B

Section B: Later dramatic tragedies

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	6
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Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

‘Linda is presented as a marginalised figure. She has no real tragic significance within the play.’

Discuss this view of the play.

[25 marks]

or

0	7
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Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

‘It is impossible for an audience to have any sympathy for Stanley. He is a fatally flawed character, the tragic villain of the play.’

How far do you agree with this view of the way that Stanley is presented in the play?

[25 marks]

or

0	8
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Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

To what extent do you agree with the view that an audience is unlikely to find anything that is positive in the ending of *Hedda Gabler*?

[25 marks]

or

0	9
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Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

‘*Waiting for Godot* is about facing up to the tragedy of simply being alive.’

To what extent do you agree with this reading of the play?

[25 marks]

or

1	0
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Brian Friel: *Translations*

To what extent do you agree with the view that Hugh is both the most significantly tragic character within the play, and its most heroic figure?

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

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